Romans

God's Judgment of
The Religious Man
Ch. 3

The Predicament of Mankind

"The wrath of God is revealed…" "…For all have sinned…"

Romans 1 : The "Pagan Man"

- *For **Suppressing** God's Truth (v.18)*
- *For **Ignoring** God's Revelation (v.19-20)*
- *For **Perverting** God's Glory (v.21-23)*

Romans 2 : The "Moral Man"

- *According to **Truth** (v. 2)*
- *According to **Accumulated Guilt** (v. 5)*
- *According to **Works** (v. 6)*
- *Without **Respect of Persons** (v. 11)*
- *According to **Obedience** (v. 13)*
- *According to **Secrets of the Heart** (v. 16)*
- *According to **Reality** (v. 17-29)*

Romans 3 : The "Religious Man"

- *Our **Conscience** is an **Indicator** of a **Need for Righteousness** and a basis for **Religion** (v. 2:14-15)*
- *God recognizes **Obedience** from the **Heart** (v. 2:29)*

2

The Pagan Man - They Became Fools…

Man's refusal to acknowledge and glorify God leads to a downward path:

- First, worthless thinking;
- Next, moral insensitivity; and
- Then, religious stupidity as seen in idol-worship!

The witness to God in nature is so clear and so constant that ignoring it is indefensible.

- **The pagan man's condemnation is based not on their rejecting Christ of whom they have not heard,**
- **But sinning against the Light that they do have**. *2 Corinthians 8:12*

NOTE: God's prior judgments of mankind (i.e. condemnations) reveal that He judged them apart from the Law and according to the eternal principles of His Revealed Truth (e.g. Sodom and Gomorrah, Noah's Flood).

The Moral Man – Seven Principles of God's Righteous Judgment

****** The First Law of Holes… stop digging**! ****

Let us not confuse Romans 2 with Revelation 20… at Judgment Day, there will be no reasoning nor preaching; only condemnation; based upon the Principles of God's Judgment.

The Agent of divine judgment is Jesus Christ. John 5:22, 27; Acts 17:31

Judgment

- The Same Measuring Stick (we all know and use the same stick):
  - *Romans 2:1-2*
  - *Matthew 7:1-2 (passing judgment should give us pause…)*
- *Does not imply "do not pass judgment – i.e. discernment"*
  - *1 Corinthians 2:14-16 – the spiritual man makes judgment about all things*
- Different judgments
  - Examples of prior Judgments (with condemnation) by God: Ezekiel 16:48-50 (Sodom and Gomorrah – pride **and** sexual perversion; see also Luke 17:28-30)
  - At the end: *Revelation 20:13-15 ("…treasuring up for yourself wrath…" Romans 2:5)*
  - *Even the Christian: 1 Cor. 3:11-15 (but not condemned…! John 5:24; Romans 8:1)*

The Moral Man / The Religious Man

Conscience, A Basis for Religion, 2:14-15

Conscience *is an important part of human nature…*

- *But, not an absolutely trustworthy* ***indicator of what is right****.*
- *Romans 2:14,15 are an explanation of verses 2:12,13*

One's conscience can be…

- *"good" - Acts 23:1; 1 Timothy 1:5,19*
- *"clear" - Acts 24:16; 1 Timothy 3:9; 2 Timothy 1:3; Hebrews 13:18*

But, it can also be…

- *"guilty" - Hebrews 10:22*
- *"corrupted" - Titus 1:15*
- *"weak" - 1 Corinthians 8:7,10,12*
- *"seared" - 1 Timothy 4:2*

By way of the blood of Jesus Christ, our ***conscience*** *may be…*

- *"****cleansed****" - Hebrews 9:14*

3

What is the greatest thought that ever entered the mind of Man?

"My responsibility to my Maker!" Daniel Webster

Men recognize a void in themselves…, and sometimes seek to fill that void with religion.

(basically a selfish drive) (we'll see that even in man's best effort, his corporate attempt; religion; that man is not good…)

The Righteousness of God Revealed

- God created man "in His own image."
  - Since we are persons, so is God
  - Since we have personal feelings, so has God
  - We all recognize the need for universal judgment! (we've all just judged pagan man in our reading of chapter 1…!)
  - **Implications?**
    - If God be God, He must be the judge of all. (We've all agreed, v. 2:1-2, that universal judgment is warranted.)
    - We must meet God as He is, not as we wish Him to be.
    - We need to really understand how He sees things… not as how we imagine Him to be.
    - **We don't want to hug our own delusions to our own damnation.**

Needs Analysis…? A basis for Religion… (the implications of our condition requires a solution)

S.P.I.N.

Situation – is self-evident

Problems – are experienced universally

Implications – are recognized by all

Needs Analysis – solutions are sought by all and translated by intent.

The Religious Man

Man's Attempt to Cover Himself

Romans 2:17-29; 3:1-8

- *Specifically addressing the **Jew**; **exemplar of the religious person**; who is **proud of the law, but not keeping it**.*

Basis of Jewish Pride

- *Being called a Jew (v. 17)*
- *Relied on the Law, "rest" (v. 17)*
- *Boasting of God (superior attitude, v.19)*
- *Knowing God's Will (v. 20)*
- *Being instructors of the Law (v. 21)*

But, all men could see their self-righteous hypocrisy

- ***"For 'the name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles because of you'…"*** *Isaiah 52:5; Ezekiel 36:22*

***Reality counts with God**…!*
*"…but **he is a Jew who is one inwardly**; and circumcision is that of the **heart**, in the Spirit, not in the letter..." (v. 2:29) (Deut. 10:16-17)*

4

Read 2:17 thru 3:8

Were the Jewish people "better" (e.g. culturally) than others?

- Arguably "yes"… compare OT laws about health and living systems vs. others (e.g. hygiene, food restrictions, "keepers of God's Laws")
- Jews had set aside the "hope of the Messiah" as the Light (even unto Gentiles) and assumed themselves to be the Light.
- i.e. arrogant conceit
- They had the "form of the Law", an adaptation of the "original Law"
- Paul uses the very Law the Jew trusts in to "root him out"….

Note: Historically, the Church had begun in the Jewish community; most of the early Christians (in the years after pentecost) were Jews. But, here we are 30-40 years since then and the Church had largely become a Gentile phenomenon. Paul (as he traveled and preached in the synagogues) undoubtedly faced a hostile, taunting, perhaps demeaning audience of Jews. Hence, his focus on a Jewish centered argument from that perspective.

Sub-argument (circumcision is of the heart – **Deut 10:16**):

- The Jew (*being* circumcised under the law) would not receive covering under the law *without* obedience…
- And, the Gentile (*not being* circumcised under the law) could receive covering under the law *with* obedience (argument from v. 2:13)…
- Therefore, the Jew would argue (tauntingly)… **Romans 3:1-8**
    - What advantage is there in being a Jew…? If we are made right with God by His Grace alone, then…
    - Isn't it the case then that our unrighteousness further increase God's glory…?
    - ***Discuss Job 38:1-3; Job 40:2; Job 40:8***
    - Discuss Psalm 51:4
    - (similar argument today – is baptism really necessary then?)

The Starting Place of Faith (God's Truth is not determined by our assessment of it…):

- *3:3 "Let God be true and every man a liar…"*
    - *We all know about truth because we all comprehend what a lie is… (the negative reveals the positive)*

- *3:4 Men are judging God…! (Psalm 51:4) Man says… "God doesn't have the right to judge me..! I am as he has made me…" Discuss Job 40:8*

- *3:5-9 Paul assents to their argument and then demonstrates how the argument can't be true because it contradicts God's own nature… (How can a perfectly just God not apply justice?)*
- Sin is born of motivation….! Who is really good?

The Religious Man

The Law Reveals our Condition

"Would you indeed annul My judgment? Would you condemn Me that you may be justified?" Job 40:8

*"There is **none righteous**, no, not one;*
*There is **none** who understands;*
*There is **none** who seeks after God." Romans 3:10-11*

*"Hear my prayer, O LORD, Give ear to my supplications! In Your faithfulness answer me. And **in Your righteousness**. **Do not enter into judgment with Your servant**, For **in Your sight no one living is righteous**." Psalm 143:1-2*

*"Now we know that whatever **the law says**, it says to those who are under the law, **that every mouth may be stopped, and all the world may become guilty before God**. Therefore, by the deeds of the law **no flesh will be justified** in His sight, **for by the law is the knowledge of sin**."*
Romans 3:19-20

Romans, chapter 3, illustrates that even the Religious Man is impoverished… none can keep the <u>theoretical sanctification of the Law</u>.

The Religious Man looks to the practice of religion for justification. He recognizes the Sin Nature of Man and seeks to "work" his way to a "right" relationship with his god.

The Law (i.e. religion – even the best corporate attempt) offers a <u>theoretical</u> promise of Justification…

> 2:6-7 "...who will render to each one according to his deeds: *eternal life to those who by patient continuance in doing good seek for glory, honor, and immortality…*"
> 2:13 "…for not the hearers of the law are just in the sight of God, *but the doers of the law will be justified…*"

The Law will offer salvation to you… but it will simply draw you out… to the realization of sin… and it will lead you to condemnation… to give up your excuses… and accept your condition in humility… your realization of guilt… v20

*We thus see that **Religion** (even that of the righteous **Law**) thus reveals the **failure of man's best corporate effort to attain to God's righteousness**..!*

Read 3:9

Transition Point – Paul again turns the argument onto the Jury (i.e. you and I)… He has baited us again!

> 3:9… "What then?" another transition point in Paul's theological argument. He has entrapped us again!

The Law (i.e. religion – even the best corporate attempt) offers a theoretical promise of Justification…

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> 2:13 "…for not the hearers of the law are just in the sight of God, *but the doers of the law will be justified…*"

We all here recognize and agree that our best attempts to attain self-righteousness do not attain to God's Truth… our motivations bely our sin condition!

Paul intends to convict his audience… to enable them to realize that they themselves are under the judgment of sin…

He proved the pagan man to be under sin…

He proved the moral man cannot overcome sin…

He proved that the religious (self-righteous) man is condemned by the Law…

Sin is born of motivation…! Who is really good? Man seeks glory… and ends with selfish pride and self-righteousness.

	Christianity	Islam	Secular Humanism	Marxism-Leninism	Cosmic Humanism	Post-Modernism
Foundation	Bible	Qur'an, Hadith, Sunnah	Humanist Manifestos I, II, III	Marx, Engels, Lenin, Mao	MacLaine, Spangler, Chopra	Neitzsche, Foucault, Derrida
Theology	Theism (Trinitarian)	Theism (Unitarian)	Atheism	Atheism	Pantheism	Atheism
Philosophy	Super-naturalism	Super-naturalism	Naturalism	Dialectical Materialism	Non-Naturalism	Anti-Realism
Ethics	Moral Absolutes	Moral Absolutes	Moral Relativism	Proletariat Morality	Moral Relativism (Karma)	Cultural Relativism
Biology	Creationism	Creationism	Neo-Darwinian Evolution	Punctuated Evolution	Cosmic Evolution	Punctuated Evolution
Sociology	Traditional Family, Church, State	Polygamy, Mosque, Islamic State	Non-Traditional Family, Church, State	Classless Society	Non-Traditional Family, Church, State	Sexual Egalitarianism
Politics	Justice, Freedom, Order	Islamic Theocracy	Liberalism, Secular World Gov.	Statism, Communist World Gov.	Self-Government New World Order	Leftism

They (i.e. world religions) can't all be true!

Comparing competing world-views

Reference: "Understanding the Times, The Collision of Today's Competing Worldviews", David A. Noebel

The Religious Man looks to the practice of religion for righteousness. He develops exhaustive belief systems. He recognizes the Sin Nature of Man and seeks to "work" his way to a "right" relationship with his god.

God reveals Himself to mankind via his special revelation of sin under the Law (i.e. via the prototypical Jew) and points mankind instead to redemption by grace within Christ.

Man says…

Humanism – man is the measure of all things.

Atheism – god doesn't exist.

Pantheism – creation itself is the measure of all things.

God says…

Hebrews 1:1 "God, who are various times and in various ways spoke in time

past to the fathers by the prophets, has in these last days spoken to us by His Son, whom He has appointed heir of all things, through whom also He made the worlds; who being the brightness of His glory and the express image of His person, and upholding all things by the word of His power, when He had by Himself purged our sins, sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high,…"

The Righteousness of God Revealed

How the LORD delights in keeping his promises…!

"'Behold, the days are coming,' says the LORD, 'That ***I will raise*** *to David* ***a Branch of righteousness****; A King shall reign and prosper, And* ***execute judgment and righteousness*** *in the earth. In His days Judah will be saved. And Israel will dwell safely; Now this is* ***His name*** *by which He will be called:* ***THE LORD OUR RIGHTEOUSNESS****. '" Jeremiah 23:5-6*

"He shall see the labor of His soul, and be satisfied. By His knowledge ***My righteous Servant shall justify many, For He shall bear their iniquities****." Isaiah 53:11*

*"****For He made Him who knew no sin to be sin for us, that we might become the righteousness of God in Him****." 2 Corinthians 5:21*

7

FIRST, Read Galatians 3:19-29

The Promises of GOD are the currency upon which man-kind's ultimate hope and destiny rest. Discuss how GOD made promises to Abraham, Moses and the Israelites, and to us (Jer 31:31).

What should our response be?

Needs Analysis: Mankind NEEDS a Savior!

The Grace of God Revealed

How *the* perfectly just LORD *has* forgiven sin…!

*"Blessed is he whose transgression is **forgiven**,*
*whose sin is **covered**,*
Blessed is the man to whom
*the **LORD** does **not impute iniquity**,*
*And in whose spirit there is **no deceit**."*

- ***Psalm 32:1-2**; **Romans 4:7-8***

*"…that **He** might **be just and the justifier** of the one who has faith in Jesus." Romans 3:26*

FIRST - Read Romans 3:21-26

THE QUESTION:

- How can a perfectly **just** God forgive sins?
- How can **sinful** man find favor with a **righteous** God?

THE ANALOGY:

- God (the Son) presides as the Judge of mankind (pagan, moral, and spiritual men). John 5:22
- The Son steps down from the Judgment seat and assumes the seat of the plaintiff (mankind). Isaiah 53:11
- The Son himself assumes the just penalty of sin for all of sinful mankind.
- The Father is satisfied with the just payment for sin.
- The Father demonstrates mercy by extending the righteousness of one man to cover many. 2 Cor. 5:21

God demonstrates His perfect justice at the same time that he demonstrates His perfect mercy… in the act of delivering justice, he also justifies.

Eph. 2:8 “For by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of God, not of works, lest anyone should boast.

Hallelujah! What a Savior!

Destiny (Where are we going?)

Faithfulness to GOD Leads to a Hopeful Eternal Future

Psalm 16:9-11 *Therefore my heart is glad, and my glory rejoices; My flesh also will rest in hope. For You will not leave my soul in Sheol, Nor will You allow Your Holy One to see corruption. You will show me the path of life; In Your presence is fullness of joy; At Your right hand are pleasures forevermore.*

Psalm 23:6 *Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me All the days of my life; And I will dwell in the house of the LORD Forever.*

Psalm 37:37-38 *Mark the blameless man, and observe the upright; For the future of that man is peace. But the transgressors shall be destroyed together; The future of the wicked shall be cut off.*

Psalm 49:15 *But God will redeem my soul from the power of the grave, For He shall receive me.*

Psalm 73:24 *You will guide me with Your counsel, And afterward receive me to glory.*

PSALMS

Destiny (Where are we going?)

•**Psalm 16:9–11**: Expresses confidence that God will not abandon His faithful ones to the grave and promises eternal joy in God's presence.

•**Psalm 23:6**: Ends with the assurance of dwelling in the house of the LORD forever, hinting at a blessed eternal destiny.

•**Psalm 37:37–38**: Contrasts the peaceful future of the righteous with the tragic end of the wicked, indicating that moral choices affect one's ultimate outcome.

•**Psalm 49:15**: Declares that God will redeem the faithful from the realm of the dead, offering hope beyond physical death.

•**Psalm 73:24**: Confidently states that God will guide believers on earth and ultimately receive them into glory, pointing to a future with Him.

Destiny (Where are we going?)

Faithfulness to GOD Leads to a Hopeful Eternal Future

Matthew 25:31-46 *(Parable of the Sheep and the Goats : Jesus teaches about a future judgement where people's eternal destinies are determined by their response to Him and how they treated others.)*

Luke 23:43 *And Jesus said to him, "Assuredly, I say to you, today you will be with Me in Paradise."*

John 14:1-3 *Let not your heart be troubled; you believe in God, believe also in Me. In My Father's house are many mansions; if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you. And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again and receive you to Myself; that where I am, there you may be also.*

1 Corinthians 15:20-22, 51-58 *(Paul discusses the resurrection of the dead the imperishable body believers will inherit, affirming eternal life beyond death.)*

Philippians 3:20-21 *For our citizenship is in heaven, from which we also eagerly wait for the Savior, the Lord Jesus Christ, who will transform our lowly body that it may be conformed to His glorious body, according to the working by which He is able even to subdue all things to Himself.*

Revelation 21-22 *(Foresees a new heaven and new earth for God's people.)*

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Destiny (Where are we going?)

- **Matthew 25:31–46** (Parable of the Sheep and the Goats) : Jesus teaches about a future judgment where people's eternal destinies are determined by their response to Him and how they treated others.
- **Luke 23:43** : In conversation with the repentant thief on the cross, Jesus promises, "Today you will be with me in Paradise," indicating a future beyond earthly life for those who turn to Him.
- **John 14:1–3** : Jesus comforts His disciples by saying He will prepare a place for them in His Father's house, assuring them of an eternal home and hope beyond death.
- **1 Corinthians 15:20–22, 51–58** : Discusses the resurrection of the dead and the imperishable body believers will inherit, affirming eternal life beyond death.
- **Philippians 3:20–21** : Reminds believers that their true citizenship is in heaven, where Christ will transform their bodies to be like His glorious body.
- **Revelation 21–22** : Foresees a new heaven and new earth where God's people live forever in His presence, free from death, mourning, and pain.